

HONEYCRISP

ORIGINAL

Root-vegetable chips · Golden honey & sea salt

Product summary prepared for commercial-viability comparison.

1. Product overview

Honeycrisp Original is the debut product of a new premium snack brand. It is a sweet-and-salty root-vegetable chip made from sweet potato, beetroot, and parsnip — thinly sliced, vacuum-fried at low temperature to preserve colour and crunch, then glazed with honey and finished with sea salt. The product is plant-based, made with a short and legible ingredient list, and packaged in single-serve format aimed at busy professionals.

Shelf / e-commerce description

Three root vegetables — sweet potato, beetroot, and parsnip — thinly sliced and vacuum-fried at low temperature to keep their vibrant colour and irresistible crunch. A delicate honey glaze and a touch of sea salt strike the perfect sweet-and-salty balance. No artificial flavours, plant-based, and made for the breaks that matter. A short ingredient list. A taste that makes no compromise.

2. Product specification

Product name	Honeycrisp Original
Category	Potato / vegetable chips (crisps)
Flavour profile	Sweet-and-salty
Texture	Crispy / crunchy
Key ingredients	Sweet potato, beetroot, parsnip, honey, sea salt
Positioning	Natural, simple, premium
Target customer	Busy professionals
Target retail price	\$6 – \$10 per unit
Format	Single-serve, on-the-go (40–50 g)
Dietary	Plant-based, no artificial flavours

3. Motivation & market rationale

The product concept was selected by analysing five years of category sales data (2019–2023) across seven snack categories and 166 products, then matching the strongest market opportunity to the founder's stated preferences.

Why chips, and why this product

1. Chips are the fastest-growing category in the dataset, with a 10.2% revenue CAGR (2019–2023) — well ahead of cookies (6.3%) and crackers (5.5%). The product rides a rising wave rather than fighting a declining one.
2. The chip segment is already ~80% plant-based by revenue, so a natural, plant-based positioning is the expected norm, not an oddity.
3. The average chip sells at roughly \$3 per unit. Premium root vegetables, vacuum frying, and single-serve format justify a \$6–\$10 price point that captures premium margins within a high-growth segment.
4. Sweet-and-salty is nearly absent from the chip aisle, which is dominated by purely savoury flavours. This is a direct differentiation angle inside a large (\$9.7B) segment.
5. Single-serve, ready-to-eat format suits busy professionals who snack at the desk or between meetings — the chosen target customer.

The opportunity gap

Plotting category growth against price-per-unit reveals an empty quadrant: no category combines high growth with a high price point. Energy bars hold the price (\$6.07/unit) but not the growth (3.3% CAGR); chips hold the growth but not the price (\$3.00/unit). Honeycrisp is designed to occupy that gap — chip-segment growth at a premium price.

4. Recipe (artisanal prototype)

The following recipe is the small-batch, kitchen-scale prototype used to validate flavour before any commercial investment. It yields roughly 150–200 g of finished chips (weight drops ~80% during cooking). Prep time ~25 min; total time ~75 min including cooling.

Ingredients

Ingredient	Quantity
Sweet potatoes, peeled	2 medium
Beetroots, peeled	2 medium
Parsnips, peeled	3 medium
Avocado oil or melted coconut oil	3 tbsp
Liquid honey (raw if possible)	2 tbsp

Sea salt flakes (Guérande or Maldon)	1 tsp
Freshly ground black pepper	½ tsp

Method

1. Preheat the oven to 150°C (300°F). Position racks in the upper and lower thirds. Line 3–4 baking sheets with parchment.
2. Using a mandoline set to 1.5 mm, slice the sweet potatoes, beetroots, and parsnips into uniform rounds. Uniformity is critical — uneven thickness means some chips burn while others stay soft. Keep the vegetables separate, as they cook at different rates.
3. Soak the sweet potato and beetroot slices in cold water for 15 minutes to remove excess starch (parsnips need no soaking). Drain and dry each slice thoroughly — residual moisture is the enemy of crispness.
4. Toss the dried slices with the oil, using your hands so each slice is lightly and evenly coated. Too much oil makes greasy chips; too little makes them dry.
5. Spread the slices in a single layer with no overlap, grouping by vegetable type to manage cook times.
6. Bake for about 15 minutes, watching from minute 12. Parsnips cook fastest, beetroot slowest.
7. Remove, flip each slice, swap the trays top-to-bottom, and bake a further 8–12 minutes until the edges curl and the centres feel dry. Pull any chips that brown early.
8. Meanwhile, warm the honey over very low heat for about 1 minute until pourable — do not boil, as burnt honey turns bitter.
9. Straight out of the oven, brush each chip with a thin layer of warm honey, then immediately sprinkle with sea salt and black pepper.
10. Let the chips cool completely on the trays for 20–30 minutes. They crisp further as they cool — do not judge the final texture while warm.

5. Path to commercial production

The artisanal recipe is a flavour-validation tool, not a manufacturing spec. Three changes are required to scale, each chosen to protect quality while controlling cost:

- Liquid honey → honey powder. Liquid honey is hygroscopic and softens the chips within 3–5 days. Honey powder (75% honey solids) blends into a dry seasoning, extends shelf life, and is applied in a rotary seasoning drum.
- Oven baking → vacuum frying. Low-temperature vacuum frying (~100°C) gives superior crunch, preserves colour, and yields just 10–15% oil content. Equipment runs \$20,000–\$80,000 for an industrial unit.

- Fresh-to-fryer → seasonal IQF sourcing. Buying root vegetables on seasonal farm contracts, then slicing and flash-freezing (IQF), stabilises raw-material cost (the largest cost line) and enables year-round production.
- Air packaging → nitrogen-flushed (MAP) pouches. Extends shelf life to 6–9 months and protects crunch in transit.

Recommended route to market: a co-packer with vacuum-frying capability rather than an owned facility. Initial production runs are estimated at \$5,000–\$10,000, versus \$150,000–\$500,000+ to build out an owned line — preserving capital for marketing while the product proves demand.

6. Key risks & open questions

- Name confusion: “Honeycrisp” is a well-known apple cultivar; consumers may expect apple chips. Requires consumer name-testing and a trademark search (CIPO in Canada, USPTO in the U.S.) before brand investment.
- Margin pressure: targeting \$6–\$10 against a \$3 category average. Premium ingredients and ~80% cooking weight loss make raw-material cost high; pricing must be validated against full landed cost.
- Distribution ceiling: at a premium price, early channels are limited to specialty grocers, natural-food retailers, and direct e-commerce — not mass retail.
- Existing competition: Terra Chips and others already occupy the root-vegetable space. Differentiation rests on the sweet-and-salty profile and premium positioning, not the format itself.
- Label claims: any nutritional or health claim must comply with CFIA and Health Canada rules and be backed by a nutrition facts table.

Prepared for internal product comparison. Figures sourced from the supplied 2019–2023 snack sales dataset and current industry references. Not for external distribution.